Relative Pronouns – II

Dont as a Relative Pronoun (Of Whom / Of Which / That)

Dont is a relative pronoun which acts as an indirect object for the dependent clause which follows the preposition **"de"**. It can refer to both people and things. It is used to refer to the indirect objects of verbs or verbal expressions that include the preposition "de".

Some verbs in dependent clause for which we can use "**dont**" as relative pronoun:

Français	English
Parler de qqun/qqch	To talk about someone or something
Se souvenir de qqun/qqch	To remember someone or something
Avoir peur de qqun/qqch	To be afraid of someone or something
Être fier(fière) de qqun/qqch	To be proud of someone or something
Avoir honte de qqun/qqch	To be ashamed of someone or something
Rêver de qqun/qqch	To dream of someone or something
S'occuper de qqun/qqch	To take care of someone or something

Français	English
Voici le mec **dont** je parlais hier.	Here is the guy **whom**(**that**) I was talking about yesterday.
Nous avons besoin de sympathie **en** ce moment. C'est la sympathie **dont** nous avons besoin en ce moment.	We need sympathy **at** this moment. It is sympathy **that** we need at this moment.
JoshiMastar est une personne **dont** j'ai très peur.	JM is the person of **whom** I am very afraid.
Ivana est la seule fille **dont** Donald est fier.	Ivana is the only daughter **that** Donald is proud of.
J'ai fait un rêve bizarre **dont** je ne me souviens pas trop.	I had a weird dream **that** I don't remember much of.

Dont - To Express Possession (Whose)

Dont is also used to express possession (whose, of whom, of which).
General Structure: **Dont + Definite Article + Noun of Possession.**

Français	English
Je te présente Robert, **dont** le frère est chanteur.	This is Robert **whose** brother is a singer.
J'avais autrefois une petite amie **dont** les parents étaient fous.	I had a girlfriend once **whose** parents were crazy.
C'est Babu, **dont** la voiture est tombée en panne.	It's Babu **whose** car has broken down.
Je vous présente ma dernière création **dont** je suis très fier.	Here's my latest creation, of **which** I'm very proud.
Voilà l'actrice **dont** je connais les parents.	Here is the actress **whose** parents I know.

Note: We don't use possessive adjectives with **dont** when it is used to express possession.

Preposition + Lequel, Laquelle, Lesquels, Lesquelles (Which)

These pronouns are formed by the contraction of **Le/La/Les + Interrogative Adjective (Quel)**.

They refer to an indirect object antecedent which is preceded by prepositions. In this regard, they are similar to **preposition + qui**; however, they are mostly used for indirect objects other than people.

Français	English
lequel (m. singular)	which (one)
laquelle (f. singular)	which (one)
lesquels (m. plural)	which (one)
lesquelles (f. plural)	which (one)

Français	English
L'organisation **pour laquelle** je travaille s'appelle BBarters.	The organization which I work for is called BBarters.
C'est l'outil **avec lequel j**'ai réparé ma motocyclette.	This is the tool I repaired my motorcycle with.

La ville **à laquelle** je pense est au Japon.	The city I am thinking of is in Japan.
Les lunettes **sur lesquelles** j'ai marché sont complètement cassées !	The glasses on which I stepped are completely broken!
Les appareils **sans lesquels** je ne peux pas survivre sont mon ordinateur portable et mes écouteurs.	The appliances without which I can't survive are my laptop and my earphones.

Contractions

With "à"	With "de"
à + lequel → auquel	de + lequel → duquel
à + laquelle → à laquelle (No Change)	de + laquelle → de laquelle (No Change)
à + lesquels → auxquels	de + lesquels → desquels
à + lesquelles → auxquelles	de + lesquelles → desquelles

Français	English
J'ai besoin de lui acheter les voitures **auxquelles** elle s'intéresse.	I need to buy her the cars **that** she is interested in.
Le cinéma près **duquel** nous avons mangé s'appelle "Vijay Talkies".	The movie theatre near **which** we ate is called "Vijay Talkies".
Voici les livres **auxquels** je pensais.	Here are the books **which** I was thinking of.
BBarters est le nom de l'institut **auquel** je me suis inscrit.	BBarters is the name of the institute I have enrolled in.
Les tableaux **desquels** je te parlais sont disponibles dans une exposition à Paris.	The paintings **of which** I was talking to you about are available in an exhibition in Paris.

Lequel as Interrogative Pronoun

Lequel, Laquelle, Lesquels, Lesquelles can also be used as interrogative pronouns meaning "which one(s)".

Français	English
Parmi les films que tu as vus ce weekend, **lequel** as-tu préféré ?	Among the films that you saw this weekend, **which one** did you prefer?
Sylvie: Passe-moi les boîtes, s'il te plaît. Joel: **Lesquelles** ?	Sylvie**:** Pass me the boxes, please. Joel: **Which ones**?
H1: Je vais parler à mon professeur. H2: **Auxquels** ?	H1: I am going to talk to my professors. H2: **To which ones**?

JM: Je pense que je suis toujours amoureux de mon ex-copine. Student: **Laquelle** ?	JM: I think I am still in love with my ex-girlfriend. Student: **Which one**?

Prepositional Phrases + Lequel

When introducing a relative clause with a prepositional phrase including **de***, you use the relative pronoun **duquel**, **de laquelle**, **desquels** or **desquelles** to refer to both living beings and inanimate objects instead of dont.

Français	English
Le restaurant **près duquel** je travaille est italien.	The restaurant **near which** I work is Italian.
Il y a plusieurs raisons **à cause desquelles** vous n'avez pas réussi l'examen.	There are several reasons **due to which** you did not pass the exam.

Following are some of the prepositional phrases which use the relative pronouns "**duquel"** and **not "dont"**.

Français	English
près de	near
à la fin de	at the end of
au début de	at the beginning of
au milieu de	in the middle of
avec l'aide de	with the help of
à cause de	due to
au sujet de	about
au-dessus de	above
à partir de	from
à côté de	next to
loin de	far from
en face de	in front of